engine for Rs 70 lakh. The deal was deferred as the telephonic conversation was overheard. On 30 January 1990, Abubaker again contacted Nambi Narayanan for purchase of the drawings. On 22 January Habibullah, Sasikumaran and Chandrasekhar discussed the deal with Nambi Narayanan at Hotel Rock Holm. The deal was sealed for Rs 1.5 crore. Drawings were to be given in three lots. Two instalments were given to Fauziyya at Thampanoor bus stand and in Hotel Luciya. The third instalment was due for 5 December 1994. Nambi Narayanan received Rs 75 lakh in US dollars from Fauziyya at Hotel Luciya at the time of handing over the last instalment.

CBI report:

Abubaker was known to Nambi Narayanan since their school days. Abubaker, an assistant director of animal husbandry department in Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu, visited Nambi Narayanan during 1991-92 in connection with a job his son had applied for in ISRO. Nambi Narayanan said he would help Abubaker in case his son qualified the written test. The candidate did not qualify.

Abubaker denied having any knowledge about Vikas technology or any other technology relation to ISRO.

On the request of the CBI, LPSC director constituted a committee of senior scientists to ascertain if any documents had gone missing from LPSC. The committee submitted two reports, the first on 11 January 1995 and the second on 24 February 1995. According to the first report, there were 5,767 recorded documents in the cryo area. Out of which only four were found to be missing. In the non-cryo area, there were 33,436 documents, of which 529 were missing.

In the second report, the committee said the four cryo documents that were missing earlier were located and, thus, there were no missing documents. On checking and re-checking, the committee found only 254 of the non-cryo documents were missing. The committee noted that these missing documents constitute less than 1% of the total documents/drawings.